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NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions for
Meeting of NSC Principals Committee

DATE: September 1, 1993
LOCATION: White House Situation Room
TIME: 5:00pm - 7:00pm

SUBJECT: Summary of Conclusions of Principals Committee Meeting
on Bosnia (S)

PARTICIPANTS:

The Vice President's Office:
Leon Fuerth

State:
Warren Christopher
Stephen Oxman

USUN
Madeleine Albright

DOD
Les Aspin
Frank Wisner

White House
Sandy Berger

CIA
William Studeman
Oliver Wicklund

NSC
Jenonne Walker

JCS
Colin Powell
Barry McCaffrey

Summary of Conclusions

Public Position and Messages to Foreign Leaders

State will prepare a public statement, for use when we have more information about Geneva developments (probably Tuesday, September 2), as well as letters from Secretary Christopher to Allied and Russian foreign ministers and messages to the Bosnian parties. All will include some common themes: (S)

- General support for the Bosnians without seeming to endorse all their demands. (S)
- Interruption of the talks was premature, and all should return to the negotiations to finish the job. (S)
- NATO's air strike warning remains in effect. (S)

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- We will not consider any easing of sanctions until an agreement is being implemented in good faith. (S)
- We remain committed to the War Crimes Tribunal. Full lifting of sanctions will require Serbian cooperation with the Tribunal. (S)

Additional points for individual parties will include:

- State will instruct Ambassador Redmond to tell Izetbegovic that we are committed to helping implement a settlement even though we cannot announce a ground force role until there is an implementable agreement. At the same time, we will point out the opposition we are likely to face in the U.S. and urge him to say publicly now what he already has told us: that he would want the U.S. to help implement an agreement. (S)
- We will warn Tudjman of possible sanctions on Croatia if both he and the Bosnian Croats do not return to Geneva and show more flexibility. (S)
- Allies will be told now is the time to press the Serbs and Croats to go as far as possible to meet the minimum requirements of the victim of aggression. We further will argue that seeming to blame the Bosnians would encourage renewed Serb or Croat aggression, thus triggering NATO's air strike commitment and/or reviving our interest in lifting the arms embargo. (S)

Air Operations. JCS will look into another air exercise over Bosnian Serb troops, at a lower altitude than previous exercises, to remind them of NATO's readiness to act on its air strike warning if necessary. (S)

Sanctions Easing

The NSC Staff will work with State to further develop a concept of how sanctions might be eased if a settlement is reached and is being implemented, and what Serbian behavior we would require at each stage. A decision on when and how to share our views with allies and other will be taken later. (S)

The NSC Staff will ask Treasury to explore whether blocked Serbian assets can be used to pay war-related claims against Serbia. (S)

Implementation

We will make public our insistence that we will participate in implementing a settlement only if it is a NATO operation, authorized by the UN but under NATO's operational control. (S)

State will work with OSD and OMB to develop the concept of a voluntary fund to pay the expenses of an implementing force. (S)

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When announcing our commitment to contribute ground forces to an implementation/enforcement effort, we will say that it is for two years only with a review at the end of the first year. (S)

In order to involve Congress early in a U.S. role in implementation, we would welcome a Congressional support for our participation. The NSC Staff will draft possible wording of such a resolution. (S)

The NSC Staff will verify that calls to staffs of appropriate Congressmen and Senators have been made, alerting them to a meeting on Bosnia and Somalia toward the end of next week. (S)

Balkan conference

State will prepare a plan for encouraging the EC to propose that a Bosnian settlement be followed by a broader conference to address the Croatian UNPAS and other potentially destabilizing issues in the Balkans. (S)

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Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

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